



countries, and players approach the game.”

While Richa was away with Birmingham Phoenix in August, the Indian team held a camp to work on fitness and skills. A week before its departure for the UAE, there was another camp focused on fine-tuning skills to prepare for what India hopes will be a strong World Cup campaign.

“I think my stint at The Hundred really helped with my preparation because I had to face swing and bounce. So I kept that in mind throughout the tournament. When I got back, I adjusted my practice to handle both swing and slower surfaces. Bowlers often try to slow things down against me, so I’ve been working on using that to my advantage.”

India’s preparation for the World Cup has been somewhat unusual. After losing to Sri Lanka in the Asia Cup final in July, the team hasn’t played any international cricket, while countries like Pakistan, South Africa, Australia, and New Zealand

have been playing bilateral series to fine-tune their squads.

Richa prefers match practice over training but has adapted to the lack of competitive games.

“I like playing matches, whether they’re practice games or regular open nets. That’s when I can identify my weaknesses. In regular nets, you might hit a shot and think it’s a sure boundary, but in a match, it could go straight to the fielder. I set up cones in the nets and imagine fielders in certain positions to work on my shot-making and placement. This approach has helped me improve my batting and fine-tune my shot selection based on the delivery and the match situation.”

Richa will turn 21 just before the World Cup kicks off in Dubai and Sharjah. After some quiet training and a holiday with her family in London following The Hundred, she’s refreshed and ready for the big event.

Despite her focus, Richa still believes in having fun and hopes that energy will be contagious as

Guardian of the sticks: Richa

Ghosh’s presence behind the stumps will be key for India at the upcoming Women’s T20 World Cup. K. MURALI KUMAR

India aims for strong support in October. She also feels the gap between teams is narrowing.

“I think the World Cup is going to be really close because everyone’s playing more games and playing them well. There’s a lot of talent, and every team is improving. Just look at what Sri Lanka has achieved this past year. Ireland’s results have also been impressive, even though they aren’t in the World Cup. The whole ecosystem is improving, including us. We’re thinking about how to beat Australia and New Zealand, but now they’re also thinking, ‘How do we beat India?’ Every team is showing they deserve to be part of this international stage, which makes the competition really exciting.”

“*Bohot maza aayega. Aap sab aao aur enjoy karo* (It’ll be a lot of fun. Come and enjoy it)”, she signs off.